

FUTURE SKILLS SERIES

AI Literacy • Lesson 5 of 6

THE TASK BOARD LESSON

Robots Do the Boring Work

AI and future jobs for grades 6–8: your class runs a small recording studio and makes the calls — **automate it**, **augment it**, or **keep it human**.

Grades 6–8

45-min lesson

No prep • No devices needed



STUDENT SESSION

The Studio Task Board



Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

You run Big Dream Studio — a small recording studio. **Nia** owns the place and coaches the artists. **Ravi** runs the mixing boards. **Jaylen** runs the front desk. There's too much to do, so the crew just got an AI assistant. Your job: decide what it does — and what it never touches.

- **AUTOMATE** — boring and repeating. Hand it to AI.
- **AUGMENT** — a human makes the call, AI helps out.
- **KEEP HUMAN** — coaching, taste, being there for someone. Humans only.

THIS WEEK AT BIG DREAM STUDIO

- A.** Send the "don't forget your session" texts to this week's artists (*Jaylen*)
- B.** Rename and back up 300 audio files from last night (*Ravi*)
- C.** Write the first draft of this week's social media captions (*Jaylen*)
- D.** Mix a rough first version of a new artist's demo (*Ravi*)
- E.** Coach a nervous first-time artist through her first session (*Nia*)
- F.** Politely remind three people who haven't paid the studio (*Jaylen*)
- G.** Pick which of an artist's five new songs is the single (*Nia*)
- H.** Make the room sound less echoey and set the mics for a live band (*Ravi*)
- I.** Agree on a price with a group that wants the studio for three days (*Nia*)
- J.** Tune up the lyrics from yesterday's freestyle session (*Ravi*)
- K.** Answer the same five questions everyone emails (price, hours, parking) (*Jaylen*)
- L.** Plan the set order and vibe for showcase night (*Nia*)

SORT THE BOARD

Write a letter where you'd put it. **House rule:** every column needs at least two tasks. Disagree with your partner? Good — talk it out. That's the lesson.

AUTOMATE — HAND IT TO AI	AUGMENT — AI HELPS OUT	KEEP HUMAN — HUMANS ONLY

THE TASK BOARD LESSON • LESSON 5 OF 6

Robots Do the Boring Work



A 45-minute AI-and-future-jobs lesson. The hook: your class runs Big Dream Studio, a small recording studio with too much to do. They decide which tasks go to AI, which get AI's help, and which stay fully human — and they own the tradeoff behind every call.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Studio Task Board worksheet (1 per student)	None — fully unplugged by design	Print worksheets. That's it.

OBJECTIVES

- Students can sort real job tasks into **automate**, **augment**, and **keep human** — and explain the difference.
- Students can compare the tradeoffs of an automation choice: who wins, who loses, what can go wrong.
- Students can defend a sorting decision aloud with a clear claim and specific supporting details.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

CSTA 2-IC-20

CCSS ELA SL.6.4

ISTE 1.3.d

Full standards text, with where each is taught and assessed in the Teacher Guide.



WARM-UP — THE MOST BORING JOB EVER (7 MIN)

Ask: "What's the most boring job you can think of?" Take 4–5 answers and write them on the board. Then pick two or three and ask the class to vote on the most boring.

"Is it boring because it **REPEATS** — same thing, over and over, no decisions? Or is it 'boring' but secretly full of people stuff — helping, noticing, talking someone down?"

So, as a class: repeats → robot bait. People stuff → hold on to it. (A toll booth job repeats — but the toll collector also waves at every regular. Let students argue; the arguing is the point.)

Bridge: "Here's the honest version, no robot apocalypse: nobody knows exactly which jobs change. What we can see already: The boring, repeating parts get automated; the human parts become the job. But every time a business automates something, somebody wins, somebody loses, and something could go wrong. Today YOU make those calls — for a recording studio."

**THE TRADE — EVERY CALL HAS A COST**

Every choice helps someone, costs someone, and could backfire. (Grown-ups call this a **tradeoff** — now you know the word.) Pick **TWO** of your calls from the board and write the trade. "Because robots" is not a reason.

Call #1 — Task letter: _____ My column (circle one): **AUTOMATE / AUGMENT / KEEP HUMAN**

Who wins? _____

Who loses, or loses something? _____

What could go wrong? _____

Call #2 — Task letter: _____ My column (circle one): **AUTOMATE / AUGMENT / KEEP HUMAN**

Who wins? _____

Who loses, or loses something? _____

What could go wrong? _____

**DEFEND IT — SAY IT OUT LOUD**

Get ready to defend ONE choice to another pair — and maybe the whole room. Look up, speak up, and land the trade:

Task _____ belongs in _____

— and the trade is _____

**EXTRACT — TAKE IT HOME**

_____ of a job someone in your life actually has — family, neighbor, coach, teacher. Run their task board.

The job: _____

AUTOMATE — one boring, repeating task AI should take: _____

AUGMENT — one task where the human makes the call and AI helps out: _____

KEEP HUMAN — one task that should stay fully human, and why: _____

The move to remember: let the robots do the boring work. Leave the humans to do the human things. The people who win with AI aren't the ones who fear it — they're the ones who decide what it does.